The Payson Morning Scroll

Made Exclusively for the Mogollon's Hearth Guests

"All the news worth knowing before the mead hall opens."

The Greybeards of High Hrothgar — Publisher & Proprietor

Payson, Arizona · Sundas, the 18th of Frostfall (Sunday, October 18, 2026) · Morning Edition — Vol. 2610, No. 18 · Price: One Septim



Gandy keeps dry under the eaves while Maevy bats at the drizzle.

Skies o'er the Hold

67° / 49°

Drizzle

Sunrise 6:33 AM · Sunset 5:47 PM

Tomorrow — Drizzle, 66/52

The Moon's Reckoning



Yesterday — *Tonight* — *Tomorrow*

First Quarter

waxing toward the full moon

18th of Frostfall = October 18

Months run one-for-one all year

Sundas=Sun … Loredas=Sat

Around the Holds · The Week Ahead

Costumed Hounds, Painters, and Golfers Fill a Drizzly Sundas

Payson, Ariz.

Hail, guest, and good Sundas morning — the Rim wakes under a soft grey drizzle, bound for 67 degrees after a 49-degree dawn, with the pines dripping and the deck boards shining. Sedona answers with costumed hounds parading at Tlaquepaque, painters still at their easels for the Plein Air Festival, and golfers tee-ing up for shelter animals, while Prescott Valley rolls out its Catrina parade and Payson folk brunch down the Young road. By the Nine, wayfarer, take a cloak against the wet and go find the fun — it is out there waiting.



Costumed hounds parade, painters paint the red rocks, and the Hold cheers through the drizzle.

Happening in the Holds Today

- **Payson**

  — Sunday Brunch with Guest Chef Bee — 10 AM–2 PM, Bruzzi Vineyard, 47209 N Highway 288, Young, down the scenic road southeast of Payson; $34.99 per person plus tax and gratuity. The morning opens with warm mini pumpkin spice muffins, moves to a zesty chorizo omelette with peppers, onion, and mozzarella topped with avocado, with baked red skin potatoes and toast, and closes with chilled pumpkin chia seed pudding. A vineyard brunch in full autumn dress — call 928-462-3314 or write BruzziVineyard@aol.com for reservations.

- **Sedona**

  — Howl-O-Ween Dog Costume Parade — 10 AM–noon, check-in 9–9:30 AM, Tlaquepaque Arts & Shopping Village, Sedona; registration $20, benefiting the Humane Society of Sedona. Costumed canines parade through the courtyards for $100 prizes as Doggone Cutest, Craziest Canine, and Leaders of the Pack, with a 50/50 raffle and swag bags besides. Dress up your dog, yourself, or the whole family. Spectators line the route — pure Sedona charm with wagging tails.

  — Sedona Community Farmers Market — winter hours — 11 AM–3 PM, Wells Fargo Bank parking lot, 2201 W State Route 89A, West Sedona. The market settles into its Sunday winter hours with live music and vendors offering pastured chicken, grass-fed beef, artisan bakery goods, fish, honey, eggs, and pot pies. Seasonal produce, specialty foods, and handmade crafts fill out the stalls. Leashed, well-behaved dogs are welcome. A slow Sunday browse under the red rocks.

  — Tee Up for Tails — Verde Valley Humane Society Golf Outing — registration 7:30 AM, 9 AM shotgun start, scramble format, at Sedona Golf Resort, 35 Ridge Trail Dr, Sedona; $160 per golfer including 18 holes, a cart, lunch, balls, and tees. This fourth annual outing raises funds for shelter animals, with raffles, closest-to-the-pin and longest-drive prizes, and a $25,000 hole-in-one prize waiting on one lucky swing. Golfers of any level may sign up alone or in pairs and be teamed in fours.

- **Show Low**

  — Show Low Film Festival — closing day — today at WME Village 8, 1501 W White Mountain Blvd, Pinetop-Lakeside. The eight-years-running festival of independent film, with about 100 selected projects, closes its run with a free Sunday showcase block — the gentlest-priced ticket in the White Mountains all weekend. Filmmakers and movie lovers have filled the theatre since Thursday with film blocks and workshops on screenwriting, music in film, and pitching. Come catch the last pictures before the credits roll on this year.

- **Prescott**

  — 2026 Catrina Parade and Competition — 2–4 PM, Prescott Valley Town Center Turf Park, 2980 Park Ave, Prescott Valley. A colourful Día de los Muertos celebration: individuals, families, groups, and businesses parade in traditional Catrinas, Catríns, and holiday-inspired characters, then compete for prizes. The parade steps off first, the costume competition follows, and winners are named from about 3 PM. All ages welcome, and the spectacle alone is worth the drive — bring the family and cheer the finery.

  — Prescott Valley Community Market — 11 AM–3 PM, Prescott Valley. A family-friendly Sunday market built to support local artisans, small businesses, and food creators, with handmade goods and good things to eat spread across the stalls. It pairs neatly with the Catrina Parade nearby in the afternoon — browse the market late morning, take lunch from a vendor, then wander over for the parade at two. A full, easy Sundas outing in one town.

  — CrafTea Time: Ghost Garland — 2–3 PM, Prescott Public Library, Prescott. The library's CrafTea Time invites adults of all skill levels to sip tea and make a Halloween ghost garland with instructor Danielle Derois in a relaxed, hands-on crafting session. No experience needed — just bring your Sundas-afternoon patience and leave with a string of friendly ghosts for the mantel. A quiet, cozy counterpoint to the parades, and the garland is yours to keep.

The Days Ahead

- **Mon, Oct. 19**

  — **D.A. Ranch Paint Out — Sedona Plein Air Festival** — 4–7 PM, D.A. Ranch, Cornville; $45 per guest, limited tickets. Watch festival artists paint across the ranch grounds from 4–6 PM, among the historic red barn, pastures, ponds, orchards, and vineyards. Awards and an exclusive sale of the works created that very afternoon follow at 6:30 PM. D.A. Ranch wines are for sale, with a grazing table and live music. Golden-hour art, wine, and music in the Verde Valley.

- **Tue, Oct. 20**

  — **Trail Day Volunteer Build** — 7 AM–noon, on Hwy 87 just before Pine, with PINE Strawberry Fuel Reduction. “Don’t just use the trail — help build it”: volunteers clear brush, move rocks, break roots, and shape a trail the community will use for years. The work also creates better access routes for firefighters and emergency crews. Tools are provided; bring water, sunscreen, gloves if you have them, and sturdy shoes. Email trails@psfuelreduction.org for directions.

  — **Sedona Plein Air Festival — artist demonstration** — 1–3 PM, free, Sedona Arts Center, 15 Art Barn Rd, Sedona. A festival artist demonstrates the plein air craft live, turning red-rock light into a finished canvas in two hours while you watch. The festival runs through Saturday, Oct. 24, with 26 artists painting across Sedona and the Verde Valley. This free demonstration is the easiest way in — no ticket, just curiosity. Arrive a little early for a good spot.

- **Wed, Oct. 21**

  — **Long-Term Water Management Plan Community Meeting** — 1–3 PM, Prescott Public Library, 215 E Goodwin St, Prescott. City staff open with a 45-minute presentation on Prescott’s water supplies, current and future needs, and strategies for conservation and efficiency. Information stations follow, where residents can talk one-to-one with City representatives and take a community survey. Can’t attend? The survey is online, and your input still feeds the plan’s first draft. Dry-country homework that truly matters.

  — **Paint Out at a Private Sedona Residence** — 4–7 PM, private Sedona residence, address with ticket; $60 per guest, limited tickets. The Plein Air Festival’s most intimate evening: a small audience watches artists paint from 4–6 PM amid sweeping red-rock views. Awards and an exclusive sale of the afternoon’s works begin at 6:30 PM. Wine, beer, and Southwest BBQ are served as the sun sets. Part art show, part garden party, part treasure hunt.

- **Thu, Oct. 22**

  — **Camp Carpe Diem Verde Valley 2026 opens** — Oct. 22–25, basecamp at Verde River RV Resort & Cottages, Camp Verde; ticketed. A grown-up camp and “UnRally” for RVers, van-lifers, tent campers, and travellers: four days exploring the valley’s hiking, biking, breweries, wineries, and ghost towns. Organisers handle the details; campers pick how much or how little to do, with community dinners along the way. This year’s edition lands at peak fall colour. Come for the adventure; stay for the company.

- **Fri, Oct. 23**

  — **Paint & Sip “Three Ghosts”** — 6 PM, 100 N White Mountain Rd, Ste 101, Show Low. A Halloween-week paint night: settle in with a brush and a sip to create “Three Ghosts,” a seasonal canvas to take home. The listing points painters to Kittles Fine Art for full information and registration under “Upcoming Classes.” A relaxed Fredas-evening way to start the last weekend before Halloween. The ghosts, we are assured, are friendly ones.

- **Sat, Oct. 24**

  — **Morning Café — Unity of Payson** — 9:30 AM–12:30 PM, 110 E Bonita, Payson, and on Zoom every Saturday. A gentle, coffee-hour start to Loredas: good company and an uplifting talk to open the day. It runs every Saturday, so guests can join from the Hearth by Zoom without driving anywhere. Check unityofpayson.org for the blue Zoom link.

  — **Sedona Plein Air Festival — closing day** — 10 AM–2 PM, Sedona. The festival’s last day brings artist pumpkin painting, a community paint-out with a $15 registration — your own brushes welcome — and a final sale of the week’s fresh paintings. Nine days of red-rock canvases come down to one morning: watch, paint, or carry a piece of Sedona home. A fine Loredas finale for art lovers, Valley Dwellers included.

Quests of the Hearth

Quests awaiting:



The Hearth shield on the workbench, with the torch sconces lined up beside it.

- ☐ **Design & prep the torch sconces** — Overdue since Sept. 26 — draw the sconces and ready them before a single torch can burn.
- ☐ **Print the torch sconces** — Overdue since Oct. 3 — the printers stand ready; give them their orders.
- ☐ **Finish & install the torches** — Overdue since Oct. 10 — hang the finished torches and light the way.
- ☐ **Build the Mogollon's Hearth shield** — Overdue since Oct. 17 — the Hearth's arms take shape at last.
- ☐ **Mount the shield by the front door** — Due Oct. 24 — hang it on a French cleat where every guest can see it.
- ☐ **Doors — Mogollon Hearth** — Due Oct. 24 — the Hearth's doors are next on the quest board.

The shield build is overdue since Saturday, Oct. 17 — and the torches still wait, wanting their sconces printed and hung.

Merchant of the Hold

Duza's Kitchen · *Payson*



The Shepherd's Biscuit arrives — tall, golden, and worth the wait.

A farm-to-table American kitchen set in a converted house on Main Street, with a dog-friendly patio and a chef who comes out to check on his guests. The signature plate is the Shepherd's Biscuit — piled with bacon, brisket, Italian sausage, avocado, ricotta, and eggs — with the Rim County Trout stuffed with crab and the crab-and-shrimp crepe close behind, and cinnamon rolls worth the trip alone. Some small kindly enchantment keeps every biscuit tall and every crepe golden, or so the regulars swear.

> *"Consistent. Amazing. Immaculate. There's literally nothing on the menu that is not delightful and wonderful."* — Restaurantji review

703 W Main St, Payson, AZ 85541 · Sun 8 AM–2 PM; Thu–Sat 8 AM–2 PM and 5–8 PM; closed Mon–Wed · 928-363-4011 · $$ (moderate) · Good to know: open only Thu–Sun and the house is small — about ten tables — so a short wait at busy brunch times is normal; the patio welcomes dogs. · their scrying-mirror page (other travelers call it a 'website')

Why the Hearth sends you: The finest Sunday brunch in the Hold — a real chef's kitchen in a cozy house, and the Shepherd's Biscuit is a quest reward all by itself.

Tales from the Treeline

The Pancake That Would Not Land



The great flip — one pancake, one gust, one very dignified hat.

Sundas dawned drizzly, and Gus (an orc baker) marked it the only proper way: one enormous pumpkin pancake on the Hearth deck, wide as a cartwheel, flipped high enough to need a witness. Mabel (a wood elf) appointed herself witness, mostly to say she had warned him.

The flip was perfect. The landing was not. A gust off the Rim took the pancake sideways, and Flurry (a young ice-breathing dragon) zigzagged after it with a tray, tail kink and all, while Henny (the Hearth's chicken) ran the deck below like a one-bird ground crew.

That dang pancake sailed clean over the tray, over Henny, and settled — soft as you please — square on Earl's antlers, where it sat like a grand golden beret. Earl (an elk) stood very still, wearing his breakfast with complete dignity, and declared it the finest hat in the Hold. Gus agreed, and served the next one on a plate, like a coward.

Printed with pride in Payson, in the shadow of the Rim · Set in hot metal by Dude, Bard of the Morning Scroll · May your Sundas be free of trolls, Clay.

Ask the Hearth ✉

…or write to us straight: mogollonshearth@gmail.com